proficiency in React, decided to pursue a more senior, higher-paying frontend position at an AI startup. She submitted her application through an online portal.

After a recruiter verified her qualifications and confirmed that she met the job requirements, Jane felt excited about the upcoming interviews. Having spent several years in her current role, she was confident in her ability to answer general questions about her past projects and contributions. She had practiced medium-level algorithm coding, believing that her preparation and accumulated work experience would give her an edge during the interview process.

Despite her confidence, Jane found herself slightly confused as she reviewed the structure of the interview process. Unlike her previous job search experiences, this series of interviews was designed to comprehensively evaluate not only her technical skills but also her system design knowledge and soft skills. In the past, frontend interviews had primarily focused on a few theoretical questions about HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, along with some straightforward coding exercises. Algorithmic challenges were typically less demanding than those for backend or full-stack roles, and discussions often revolved around her past projects. However, Jane noticed that modern frontend interviews have evolved significantly to reflect the increasing complexity of web applications and the growing overlap between frontend and backend responsibilities.

During one interview, Jane was tasked with implementing a star rating component using React. She demonstrated her technical expertise by building the solution with functional components, utilizing React hooks to manage both the current rating and the hover state. Jane also employed CSS Flexbox to neatly arrange the stars, resulting in a clean and interactive UI. Although she delivered a fully working solution that met all the requirements, Jane later realized she might not have effectively articulated her thought process and problem-solving strategies. This missed opportunity prevented her from showcasing a deeper understanding of her approach.

The system design questions caught Jane off guard. As a frontend engineer, she was surprised to be asked about backend services and performance issues. Questions about REST APIs, caching strategies, database services,